

Renaming Tux

Dear Vinit Aggarwal,
Your January 2003 editorial neatly puts into place the need of the hour—branding and selling Linux. During the early 1990s, well before Windows 95 was released, Marty Taucher, Director of Public Relations at Microsoft, pointed out that an exhaustive research by Microsoft revealed that home users wanted an enjoyable and friendly OS. This is precisely what Linux flavours must offer their potential users to become a formidable alternative to Windows. Linux needs to be branded, and in a hurry. And the time is just right, now that excellent user-friendly versions of Linux have been released.

Krishnakumar J. Rao
Via e-mail

digit

Dear Krishnakumar,
Yes. The current brand values of Linux present an interesting challenge for its evangelists—low cost, stability, security and flexibility aren't good enough to popularise Linux on the desktop. A change in the user perception that Linux is not friendly and is only for geeks is urgently needed. And with the release of desktop environments such as KDE and Gnome, the OS has indeed matured to a level where a new PC user would not feel intimidated. However, changing perceptions requires a concerted, well-orchestrated marketing endeavour, which is easier said than done.

Play wary

Dear Shri Aggarwal,
I have been buying your magazine for quite some time and I have an unpleasant experience to share with you. After having installed a game from the Playware CD, my computer developed a serious problem. All icons displayed themselves in an enlarged form and the application windows were not visible in the screen area. I had to call a service engineer, but nothing worked and I had to reformat my disk to get rid of the problem. This experience has deterred me from buying your magazine in the future.

Aditya Rath
Via e-mail

digit

Dear Mr Rath,
We sympathise with your unfortunate experience. We try our best to check every software application that's provided on the Digit CDs, but we cannot guarantee that they will work on every PC. Even though it's possible that the game you installed could have played havoc with your system configuration, it's highly unlikely. Your problem sounds more like a simple condition of the game changing your desktop resolution to a lower setting, which in no way requires reformatting and reinstalling Windows. In any case, if you could send us the name of this truant game, we will investigate it further to avoid similar goofs in the future.

Stop repeating yourself!

Dear Digit,
I would like you to note one point in your December 2002 issue. Even though the issue was good overall, it 'boasted' of the word 'boasts'. Please try to go easy on that word in the future. Your reader,

Shrinidhi Rao
Via e-mail



digit

Dear Shrinidhi,
We didn't realise that we were repeating ourselves so much. Obviously, repeating any word over and over again sounds repetitive and could lead to angry letters from our readers, where we are pointedly told to stop repeating words that make us sound repetitive. Believe me, we never intended to repeat that word so many times as to be considered repetitive :)

Make a wish

Sir,
Based on the graphics chips review carried out by Digit in the August 2002 issue, I went to purchase a new video card. But the whole exercise left me perplexed. While Digit only focused on the graphics chipsets and their performance, the cards available in the market have different features such as TV-In/Out, S-Video and Composite connectors, TV tuning, video capture, etc. I expect Digit to do a more comprehensive review of graphics cards inclusive of such add-ons or at least an explanation and review of these features.

Ajay
Via e-mail

digit

Dear Ajay,
You are either a mind reader, or just plain lucky! In any case, we are doing a comprehensive graphics card test next month, which should answer all your questions. In the meantime, could you predict which country will win the Cricket World Cup this month?

digit READERPOLLS

Q. What would you like featured in the 'Off the Shelf' section?

Sci-fi movies	Sci-fi books	Edutainment CDs
60%	5%	35%

Look ma, they even plan on having film reviews in Digit!

Your vote counts

This month's question:

Would you like detailed and more game reviews in 'Off the Shelf', instead of the game feature in Arcade?

Log on to www.thinkdigit.com and vote on it